

CEDRIC NIAMBA, MBA

DALLAS FORT WORTH METROPLEX AREA | CEDRICNIAMBA@GMAIL.COM | 240-821-0771

AWS CERTIFIED SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT

Cloud Engineer and Platform Architect with over a decade of experience designing, securing, and scaling infrastructure for mission-critical systems in both government and enterprise environments. Deep expertise in AWS and Azure, infrastructure as code (Terraform), Kubernetes, and cloud-native security tooling. Proven success in guiding cloud migration efforts, implementing FedRAMP/NIST 800-53 compliant environments, automating observability stacks, and enforcing zero-trust principles. Known for bridging cloud engineering with cloud security to deliver resilient, efficient, and compliant systems.

U.S. Citizen | Active DoD Secret Security Clearance

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SR PLATFORM ENGINEER (CONTRACTOR: KONIAG GS)
U. S. ARMY—Fort Belvoir, VA
U.S. Branch Department of Defense.

Oct 2023 - Present

Provide technical leadership in AWS GovCloud architecture, guiding enterprise application owners through secure cloud modernization, migration, and alignment with Army cloud adoption frameworks.

- Architect and maintain platform-level services spanning networking, OS, storage, high availability, and DR, boosting system resilience and achieving 99.95% uptime SLA for mission-critical workloads.
- Designed and enforced AMI governance by restricting usage through tags and Service Control Policies (SCPs), resulting in a 30% reduction in non-compliant image usage.
- Directed infrastructure-as-code deployments using Terraform; maintained over 50 reusable modules aligned with NIST and DoD baselines.
- Automate RDS backup as Kubernetes CronJob. Task involves: Postgres Docker build with pre-baked RDS dependencies, CronJob Helm Chart Configuration, Helm plugins configuration with sops encryption, Cronjob deployment resulting in automated RDS backup dump in S3.
- Define scalable Kubernetes architecture using EKS across multi-AZ, implemented Pod Security Policies, and network segmentation.
- Implement secure landing zones, HADR, and compliance with NIST 800-53 and DISA STIG guidelines.

DEVSECOPS ENGINEER (CONTRACTOR: RANDSTAD)
GENERAL DYNAMICS MISSIONS SYSTEMS (GDMS)—Arlington, VA

Mar 2023 - Oct 2023

American defense and aerospace company providing mission critical solutions to U.S government.

Architected full observability stack in AKS using Terraform and GitLab CI: Prometheus Operator, Jaeger, Kiali, Alertmanager, Blackbox Exporter, Grafana, and Istio. Integrated OPA Gatekeeper policies and Azure AD to enforce RBAC and deployment constraints at scale.

- Implemented OpenTelemetry for unified tracing, metrics, and logs, improving observability and reducing monitoring overhead.
- Introduced Kubecost with real-time metrics on memory, CPU, and per-namespace cost breakdown driving usage-based chargebacks across teams; reduced MTTR by 40% and provided real-time cost visibility.
- Managed hybrid-cloud integrations, optimizing data transfer between on-premises systems and Azure cloud storage.
- Integrated container vulnerability scanning in GitLab pipelines; surfaced CVE reports through custom Slack and Prometheus alert workflows.

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE, *CONTINUED*

DEVSECOPS ENGINEER (CONTRACTOR: PISTIS)

Aug 2021 - Mar 2023

GENERAL SERVICE ADMINISTRATION (GSA)—Washington DC

United States government agency managing and supporting the basic functions of federal agencies.

Led the agency's Cloud Center of Excellence (CoE) adoption initiative, driving scalable cloud integration while transitioning app and platform teams to GitOps workflows.

- Built GitLab pipelines that integrated container vulnerability scans (Trivy) and IaC policy checks (Regula/OPA), blocking over 25 misconfigured deployments pre-prod.
- Configured Terragrunt.hcl files to deploy App server's backup stacks for compliance routine stacks.
- Introduced self-service documentation via Confluence with Architecture Decision Records (ADRs) for critical systems.
- Embedded security scans (SAST/DAST) and linting into pipelines for Lambda and container-based workloads.
- Migrated core workloads to AWS using CloudFormation and S3 lifecycle policies, reducing on-premises dependency and storage costs by 35%.
- Hardened data platforms (RStudio, SAS Viya, Colibra) with TLS and AWS KMS encryption, directly enabling ATO approval under FedRAMP Moderate.
- Configured K8 secrets using sops encryption to harden Infrastructure as Code (IaC).
- Hardened Kubernetes clusters by implementing network policies, role-based access control (RBAC), and securing container images with vulnerability scanning tools.

SITE RELIABILITY ENGINEER (CONTRACTOR: ADNET)

Jul 2017 - Aug 2021

U.S. TRADE AND DEVELOPMENT AGENCY (USTDA)—Arlington, VA

United States government agency promoting U.S. Exports and job growth as well as economic development overseas.

Engineered a high-performance data pipeline for real-time analytics, empowering federal agencies with faster insights, while resolving full-stack web application issues to ensure seamless user experience and system reliability.

- Developed scalable Jenkins-based CI/CD pipelines; introduced reusable shared libraries for IaC modules.
- Wrote Python-based ETL logic interfacing with both document-based (JSON, XML) and relational datasets; exposed functionality via API Gateway.
- Delivered post-deployment validation scripts used across multiple environments, minimizing manual verification time.
- Designed monitoring dashboards and telemetry pipelines for SQL Server and PostgreSQL databases.
- Modernized and extended Docker build scripts (tomcat, docker-r, docker-r-packages, docker-r-python) by integrating essential libraries and dependencies; automated image builds and pushed optimized containers to Docker Hub for enterprise-wide use.
- Deployed client-specific apps by configuring NGINX proxies, setting up databases on a central server, containerizing applications, and validating DNS routing.
- Wrote Bash/Python scripts for network health checks, disk IO monitoring, and uptime alerting.

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE, *CONTINUED*

DEVOPS ENGINEER (CONTRACTOR: ICF)

Jun 2016 – Jun 2017

U.S. FEDERAL DEPOSIT INSURANCE CORPORATION (FDIC)—Arlington, VA

United States government corporation providing deposit insurance to depositors in U.S. banks.

Designed and implemented a cloud infrastructure project to host FDIC enterprise's deposit insurance management applications. Architected secure networks with SSL, TCP/IP, DNS and Load Balancing.

- Developed and deployed secure applications leveraging AWS services such as security groups, CodeCommit, ECS, VPC, WAF, Fargate, CloudTrail, API Gateway, and Lambda.
- Managed and optimized databases including PostgreSQL, NoSQL, Redis, and MongoDB to ensure high performance and scalability.

SYSTEMS ADMINISTRATOR

Mar 2013 – Jun 2016

RR DONNELLEY—Washington, DC

Fortune 500 firm providing printing and related services to corporate clients worldwide.

Managed the infrastructure support and cloud transitions for marketing, SC, and printing applications. Refined SQL and PL-SQL code to boost database performance, resulting in enhanced data processing efficiency and reduced latency.

- Supported 200+ Windows and Linux servers, ensuring security compliance and availability.
- Built initial automation for system provisioning and patch management in on-prem data centers.

EDUCATION

MASTER OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION (MBA), May 2013

STRAYER UNIVERSITY, Rockville, MD

3.9 GPA | Golden Key International Honor Society | Alpha Chi National Honor Society

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE (B.S.) IN BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION, May 2010

UNIVERSITY OF MARYLAND, Adelphi, MD

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS CERTIFIED SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT—PROFESSIONAL, May 2024

CompTIA SECURITY+ CE, December 2023

CERTIFIED ETHICAL HACKER—C|EH (v11), January 2021

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: Azure (Web Apps, API Gateway, Monitor), AWS (GovCloud, EC2, RDS, Lambda, EKS)

CI/CD & GitOps: GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Azure DevOps Pipelines, Git branching strategy

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, AWS CDK, CloudFormation

Observability & Monitoring: OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana, CloudWatch, Kubecost

Security & DevSecOps: OPA, ATO, Rego, Zero Trust, IAM Policies, TLS/KMS, FedRAMP, HIPAA, SOC 2, ISO 27001

Scripting & Automation: Python, Bash, YAML, JSON, Unix tools (sed, awk, grep)

Application Support: React, AWS Lambda (Python, Node.js), SQS, REST APIs, Serverless CI/CD

Tools & Platforms: Docker, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, VS Code, Jira, Confluence, Bitbucket